Lesson 4: Project: Automate One Recurring Report

Module 1 | 60 minutes | End-to-end report | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Plan your project and practise the key ideas.

1. Key words

Match each word to what it means. Write the letter.

a. pipeline ___ A. A weekly record of minutes taken (including checks) and problems caught.
b. human checkpoint ___ B. Automations send drafts only to you; you send the final version.
c. draft-to-me rule ___ C. A planned stop where a person checks before the work moves on.
d. time-saved log ___ D. All the steps of a task joined in order, from data in to message out.

2. Prompt Lab: the report comments template

Write the prompt template your report will use every week to turn dashboard numbers into 3 lines of comments for your manager. Say who it is for, tell the AI to use only the numbers you give, include sales and last week's sales, ask for up or down and the percentage change, forbid added reasons, set the length, and ask it to flag anything unclear. Write your prompt here, then try it in ChatGPT or Claude or Gemini or Microsoft Copilot.

3. In your report pipeline: let the sheet or script do it, or a human checkpoint?

Write each item in the right group: Let the sheet or script do it / Human checkpoint.

a. Adding up delivered sales with SUMIFS → _____
b. Recalculating when the week date changes → _____
c. Confirming every row says OK before using the numbers → _____
d. Building the draft email from dashboard cells → _____
e. Reading the AI's comments against the dashboard → _____
f. Colouring sales red when below target → _____
g. Forwarding the final report to the manager → _____
h. Deciding what to do about a big drop in sales → _____

4. The report pipeline

Put the report pipeline in order. Number them 1–8.

a. ___ Checkpoint C: read, fix and forward
b. ___ Script emails the draft to you
c. ___ AI drafts comments from the dashboard numbers
d. ___ Checkpoint B: one number verified with a filter
e. ___ Dashboard updates from the week cell
f. ___ Checkpoint A: every row says OK
g. ___ Data arrives in the Orders tab
h. ___ Log the time and any problem caught

5. Payback time

Setting up your automated report took 180 minutes. It used to take 70 minutes a week; now it takes 25 minutes including checks. After how many weeks has the setup paid for itself? Circle one.

a. A. 2 weeks
b. B. 4 weeks
c. C. 7 weeks
d. D. Never; setup time does not count

6. My plan

Plan your project: Automate one weekly or monthly report from data to delivery, joining a self-updating sheet, a prompt template and a draft email to yourself, with three human checkpoints and an honest time-saved log. Sketch it and list what each part will do.

7. Checklist

Tick each one when your project does it.

a. ☐ Pipeline map with checkpoints A (clean), B (numbers) and C (before sending)
b. ☐ Sheet with a check column and a dashboard driven by one date cell
c. ☐ Saved comments prompt template that uses only the dashboard numbers
d. ☐ Draft email to yourself (checked Apps Script or a Gmail/Outlook template)
e. ☐ One mistake caught at a checkpoint, explained
f. ☐ Time-saved log with before, after (including checks), setup time and payback

8. Two stars and a wish

Ask a friend to test your project. Write two things they liked and one idea to improve it.

How did it go? Colour a face: 😀 I can do it · 🙂 Nearly there · 🤔 I need help

☐ I can map a report pipeline with three human checkpoints.
☐ I can join a self-updating sheet, a prompt template and a draft email to myself.
☐ I can catch a wrong number or invented reason at a checkpoint.
☐ I can keep a time-saved log and work out the payback honestly.